

Grammar Mix — 11+ Practice

A steady spread of the grammar basics that come up again and again in 11+ papers.

NAME

Radha

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SUBJECT

Grammar

Today's focus: word classes (nouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs), verb tense and agreement, pronouns, sentence types, and simple/compound/complex sentences. Nothing here is a trick question — read each sentence carefully and use what you already know.

PRACTICE SET A

1 WORD CLASS

In the sentence "The excited dog barked loudly," which word is the adjective?

2 VERB TENSE

Choose the correct verb to complete the sentence: "By the time we arrived, the film already ____."

A had started

B has started

C starts

D was starting

3 PRONOUN

Choose the correct pronoun: "Neither Sam nor his sisters had brought ____ umbrella."

A his

B her

C their

D its

4 SUBJECT-VERB AGREEMENT

Which sentence is correct?

A The team of players were tired.

B The team of players was tired.

5 COMMON ERROR

Rewrite this sentence, correcting the error: "There was less children at the party than last year."

6 SENTENCE TYPE

What type of sentence is this: "Close the door quietly."?

A Statement

B Question

C Command

D Exclamation

7 ADVERBS

Rewrite this sentence, changing the underlined adjective into an adverb: "She spoke in a careful way." → "She spoke ____."

8 CONJUNCTIONS

Choose the connective that best completes the sentence: "We left early ____ we wanted to avoid the traffic."

A although

B because

C unless

D whereas

9 SENTENCE STRUCTURE

Is this sentence simple, compound, or complex? "Although it was raining, the match went ahead."

10 ACTIVE / PASSIVE

Rewrite this sentence in the passive voice: "The chef prepared the meal."

ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATIONS — SET A

1.

"Excited" is the adjective.

It describes the noun "dog." "Loudly" describes the verb "barked," so that's an adverb, not an adjective.

2.

Correct answer: A — had started

The film finished happening before we arrived, so it needs the past perfect ("had started") to show one past action happened before another past action.

3.

Correct answer: C — their

With "neither...nor," the pronoun agrees with the noun closest to it — here that's "his sisters" (plural), so "their" is needed, not the singular "his."

4.

Correct answer: B — The team of players was tired.

"Team" is the actual subject of the sentence (singular), not "players" — so the verb should be "was," not "were."

5.

There were fewer children at the party than last year.

"Fewer" is used for things you can count (children), and "less" is used for amounts you can't count (like water or time). "Was" also needs to become "were" to agree with the plural "children."

6.

Correct answer: C — Command

It's giving an instruction (an imperative), not stating a fact, asking something, or showing strong feeling.

7.

She spoke carefully.

Adverbs describing how something is done usually add "-ly" to the adjective — careful becomes carefully.

8.

Correct answer: B — because

The second half of the sentence gives the reason for the first half, so it needs a connective that shows cause, not contrast ("although," "whereas") or condition ("unless").

9.

Complex sentence.

It has a main clause ("the match went ahead") and a subordinate clause ("Although it was raining") that can't stand alone as a full sentence — that combination makes it complex.

10.

The meal was prepared by the chef.

In the passive voice, the thing being acted upon (the meal) becomes the subject of the sentence, and "by the chef" shows who did the action.

PRACTICE SET B — NOW YOU TRY

1 WORD CLASS

In the sentence "The tired hikers rested peacefully," which word is the adverb?

2 VERB TENSE

Choose the correct verb to complete the sentence: "Tomorrow, we ____ to visit our grandparents."

A went

B are going

C had gone

D go

3 PRONOUN

Choose the correct pronoun: "Each of the girls brought ____ own lunch."

A their

B her

C its

D them

4 SUBJECT-VERB AGREEMENT

Which sentence is correct?

A Neither of the answers were right.

B Neither of the answers was right.

5 COMMON ERROR

Rewrite this sentence, correcting the error: "She done her homework before dinner."

6 SENTENCE TYPE

What type of sentence is this: "What an incredible goal that was!"?

A Statement

B Question

C Command

D Exclamation

7 ADVERBS

Rewrite this sentence, changing the underlined adjective into an adverb: "He gave a quick reply." → "He replied ____."

8 CONJUNCTIONS

Choose the connective that best completes the sentence: "I enjoy swimming, ____ my brother prefers football."

A because

B whereas

C since

D so

9 SENTENCE STRUCTURE

Is this sentence simple, compound, or complex? "The sun set, and the sky turned orange."

10 ACTIVE / PASSIVE

Rewrite this sentence in the passive voice: "The gardener watered the plants."

ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATIONS — SET B (tutor key)

1.

"Peacefully" is the adverb.

It describes how the hikers rested (the verb). "Tired" is the adjective describing "hikers."

2.

Correct answer: B — are going

"Tomorrow" signals a planned future action, which in everyday English is usually expressed with "am/is/are going to," not the simple present or past tense.

3.

Correct answer: B — her

"Each" is singular, and here it clearly refers to "girls," so the singular feminine "her" is correct rather than the plural "their."

4.

Correct answer: B — Neither of the answers was right.

"Neither" is singular even though it's followed by a plural noun phrase ("of the answers") — the verb should agree with "neither," not "answers."

5.

She did her homework before dinner.

"Done" needs a helping verb ("had done" or "has done") to work correctly — on its own as the main verb of the sentence, the correct past tense form is "did."

6.

Correct answer: D — Exclamation

It expresses strong feeling and starts with "What," a classic exclamation-sentence opener, ending in an exclamation mark.

7.

He replied quickly.

Quick becomes quickly by adding "-ly," following the same pattern as question 7 in Set A.

8.

Correct answer: B — whereas

The sentence is contrasting two different preferences, so it needs a contrasting connective — "because," "since" and "so" all suggest cause and effect, which isn't what's happening here.

9.

Compound sentence.

It joins two complete sentences ("The sun set" and "the sky turned orange") with "and" — both halves could stand alone, which is what makes it compound rather than complex.

10.

The plants were watered by the gardener.

The thing receiving the action (the plants) becomes the subject, and "by the gardener" shows who did it — same pattern as Set A Q10.